

Getting Started with Theme Development in WordPress



A WordPress theme determines the look and basic functions of a WordPress site. There are hundreds of themes available for download—free or on payment. The WordPress website itself has a number of free themes. But when one needs a special theme for a particular need, then it's time to develop one's own theme. This article will guide the reader through the theme development process.

WordPress is a PHP and MySQL based free and open source CMS (content management system). Used in more than 23 per cent websites, it's the most powerful blogging and website content management system in existence today. Famous blogs like Mashable and TechCrunch are both on WordPress. News outlets like 'The New York Times' blogs and CNN's on-air personality blogs all use WordPress, too. It is free and can be downloaded for self-hosted installations from WordPress.org.

Themes in WordPress

A WordPress theme provides all of the front-end styling for

your site. These themes provide:

- The overall design or style of the site
- Font styling
- Colours
- Widget locations
- Page layouts
- Styles for blog posts and blog archives

Naming a WordPress theme

To build a theme in WordPress you have to be aware of its directory structure. First, create a sub-folder in the `wp-content/themes` directory in your WordPress folder, e.g.,